

Vibe Categories & Cultural Endorsement Language — Audit & Recommendations

Status: ADD TO BUILD 105 (Business Profile Card)

What Replit Currently Has

Vibe Tags (12 total — from `vibes.ts`):

ID	Label	Description	Appropriate For
date-night	Date Night	Romantic, intimate, couples	Restaurants, lounges, entertainment
group-hangout	Group Hangout	Lively, social, great for squads	Bars, bowling, events
solo-vibes	Solo Vibes	Quiet, chill, recharge energy	Cafes, bookstores, parks
bougie-treat	Bougie Treat	Upscale, elevated, special occasion	Fine dining, spas, hotels
hood-classic	Hood Classic	Authentic, local, community staple	Soul food, barbershops, corner stores
soul-food	Soul Food	Southern comfort, home cooking, real flavor	Restaurants only
late-night	Late Night	After dark, nightlife, good energy	Bars, clubs, lounges
family-time	Family Time	Kid-friendly, wholesome, all ages	Restaurants, parks, education
creative-scene	Creative Scene	Art, music, culture, expression	Galleries, studios, venues
wellness	Wellness	Health, spa, spiritual, balance	Gyms, spas, yoga
work-and-study	Work & Study	Productive, WiFi, focused energy	Cafes, coworking, libraries

adventure	Adventure Ready	Active, explorative, outdoors	Parks, tours, excursions 
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Business Categories (21 total — from `businesses.ts`):

Food & Beverage, Shopping & Retail, Beauty & Personal Care, Health & Wellness, Home & Real Estate, Home Improvement, Automotive, Professional Services, Technology, Creative Services, Events & Entertainment, Travel & Hospitality, Family & Education, Pet Services, Community & Nonprofits, Government & Public Resources, Black Professionals, Online & Mobile Businesses, Home Services, Real Estate & Housing, Community & Nonprofit

Marketplace Categories (18 total — from `marketplace.ts`):

Clothing & Accessories, Electronics & Tech, Furniture & Home, Books & Education, Baby & Kids, Sports & Fitness, Beauty & Personal Care, Food & Beverages, Art & Crafts, Hair & Beauty Services, Tutoring & Education, Home Repair, Childcare & Family, Photography & Media, Music & Entertainment, Business Services, Digital Products, Other

PROBLEM 1: Vibes Apply to Everything (Including Dentists)

The current system lets ANY business be tagged with ANY vibe. But a dentist office is NOT a "Hood Classic" or a "Date Night." Professional services need a DIFFERENT discovery mechanism.

The Fix: Business Type Classification

Every business should have a `businessType` that determines which discovery features apply:

Business Type	Vibes Apply?	Cultural Endorsements Apply?	Discovery Method
Experience (restaurants, bars, salons, entertainment, cultural sites)	 YES	 YES ("Auntie Approved", "Tía's Pick")	Vibe search + endorsements
Service (dentists, lawyers, accountants, mechanics, doctors)	 NO	 YES but different language ("Community Trusted", "5-Star Professional")	Category search + trust score

Retail (shops, boutiques, online stores)	✅ SOME (Bougie Treat, Shopping)	✅ YES ("Certified Fresh", "Community Staple")	Category + vibe hybrid
Community (nonprofits, churches, organizations)	❌ NO	✅ YES ("Community Pillar")	Category search only

Rule: Vibes are for places you GO TO for an EXPERIENCE. Not for places you go because you NEED something fixed.

Nobody says "I'm in a Hood Classic mood, let me find a dentist." But they DO say "I need a dentist I can trust — who does my community recommend?"

PROBLEM 2: Cultural Endorsement Language is Missing

The Cultural Phrases document covers REGIONAL language (Philly says "jawn," Houston says "trill") but doesn't cover CULTURAL COMMUNITY endorsements — the language that makes each diaspora community feel seen.

The Fix: Cultural Endorsement Badges

These are community-driven endorsement tags that appear on business cards when enough community members endorse a business. They should be culturally specific AND appropriate to the business type.

ENDORSEMENT LANGUAGE BY CULTURAL COMMUNITY

Black American / African American

Badge	Use When	Appropriate For
"Auntie Approved"	10+ endorsements from community	Soul food, home cooking, comfort food restaurants
"Uncle's Pick"	10+ endorsements from community	Barbershops, auto shops, sports bars
"Sunday Best"	High ratings for atmosphere/presentation	Churches, fine dining, formal venues
"Cookout Certified"	Community staple, feels like family	Casual restaurants, BBQ, gathering spots

"Real Ones Know"	Hidden gem, word-of-mouth favorite	Any experience business with loyal following
"Community Pillar"	Long-standing, trusted institution	Professional services, nonprofits, churches
"Fresh to Death"	Consistently excellent quality	Salons, barbershops, boutiques

Hispanic / Latino

Badge	Use When	Appropriate For
"Tía Approved" / "Aprobado por la Tía"	10+ endorsements from Hispanic community	Restaurants, bakeries, home cooking
"Sazón Certified"	Exceptional flavor/seasoning	Restaurants, food trucks, catering
"Como en Casa" (Like Home)	Feels like being at home	Family restaurants, cultural centers
"Abuela's Pick" / "La Favorita de Abuela"	Traditional, authentic, generational	Bakeries (panaderías), traditional restaurants
"Barrio Staple"	Community institution in the neighborhood	Corner stores, taquerias, community orgs
"De Confianza" (Trustworthy)	Reliable, honest, community-trusted	Professional services, mechanics, doctors

Ethiopian / East African

Badge	Use When	Appropriate For
"Habesha Approved"	Endorsed by Ethiopian/Eritrean community	Ethiopian restaurants, coffee shops
"Buna Certified" (Coffee Certified)	Exceptional coffee experience	Coffee shops, cafes
"Injera & Love"	Authentic, communal dining experience	Ethiopian restaurants
"Like Mama's Kitchen"	Feels like home cooking	Any restaurant with home-style feel

"Community Blessed"	Trusted by the community	Professional services, cultural centers
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Caribbean (Jamaican, Haitian, Trinidadian, etc.)

Badge	Use When	Appropriate For
"Yard Approved" (Jamaican)	Endorsed by Caribbean community	Jamaican restaurants, jerk spots
"Lakay" (Haitian — "Home")	Feels like home	Haitian restaurants, cultural spaces
"Trini Certified"	Endorsed by Trinidadian community	Doubles spots, roti shops
"Island Vibes"	Authentic Caribbean atmosphere	Restaurants, music venues, cultural events
"Real Ting"	Authentic, no shortcuts	Any Caribbean food establishment
"Manman's Pick" (Haitian — "Mama's Pick")	Traditional, home-style	Haitian restaurants, bakeries

West African (Nigerian, Ghanaian, Senegalese, etc.)

Badge	Use When	Appropriate For
"Naija Approved" (Nigerian)	Endorsed by Nigerian community	Nigerian restaurants, shops
"Chop Life Certified" (Nigerian — "Enjoy Life")	Exceptional food/experience	Restaurants, entertainment
"Mama Put" (Nigerian — street food vendor)	Authentic, affordable, delicious	Food vendors, casual restaurants
"Jollof Certified"	Outstanding jollof rice	West African restaurants
"Wahala-Free" (Nigerian — "No trouble")	Smooth, reliable service	Professional services, any business
"Chez Nous" (Senegalese — "Our Place")	Community gathering spot	Senegalese restaurants, cultural centers

Vietnamese / Southeast Asian

Badge	Use When	Appropriate For
"Phở Real"	Authentic, exceptional Vietnamese food	Vietnamese restaurants, phở shops
"Bà Nội's Pick" (Grandma's Pick)	Traditional, generational recipes	Restaurants, bakeries
"Community Gem"	Trusted by the community	Any business with strong community ties
"Flavor Certified"	Outstanding taste/quality	Restaurants, food vendors

Korean

Badge	Use When	Appropriate For
"Halmeoni Approved" (Grandma Approved)	Traditional, authentic	Korean restaurants, markets
"Daebak" (Amazing/Awesome)	Exceptional quality	Any experience business
"K-Town Certified"	Community staple in Korean community	Korean businesses, markets

Indigenous / Native American

Badge	Use When	Appropriate For
"Elder Approved"	Endorsed by Indigenous community	Cultural centers, art galleries, restaurants
"Sacred Ground"	Culturally significant location	Heritage sites, cultural centers
"Community Honored"	Respected institution	Any business with deep community roots

Brazilian

Badge	Use When	Appropriate For
"Aprovado pela Vovó" (Grandma Approved)	Traditional, authentic	Brazilian restaurants, bakeries
"Saudade Certified" (Nostalgia/Longing)	Makes you feel like you're back home	Cultural spaces, restaurants
"Comunidade" (Community)	Community gathering spot	Brazilian businesses, cultural centers

PROBLEM 3: Professional Services Need Different Language

A dentist doesn't get "Auntie Approved." But they DO need endorsement language that builds trust:

Professional Service Endorsements (Culture-Neutral)

Badge	Use When	Appropriate For
"Community Trusted"	20+ positive reviews from community	Doctors, dentists, lawyers, accountants
"5-Star Professional"	Consistent 5-star ratings	Any professional service
"Been Here for Us"	Long-standing service to community	Established professional practices
"No Judgment Zone"	Community reports feeling safe/welcome	Mental health, medical, legal
"They Get It"	Community feels understood culturally	Any professional who demonstrates cultural competence
"Referred by Family"	High referral rate from existing clients	Any professional service

PROBLEM 4: "Black Professionals" as a Category

The business categories list includes "Black Professionals" as a category. This should be removed or renamed:

- **Problem:** It implies only Black professionals are on the platform. What about Hispanic lawyers? Ethiopian doctors? Vietnamese accountants?
 - **Fix:** Remove "Black Professionals" as a category. Professional services are already covered by "Professional Services." The OWNERSHIP DESIGNATION (minority-owned, Black-owned, Hispanic-owned, etc.) handles the cultural identity — the CATEGORY should describe what the business DOES, not who owns it.
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HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS TOGETHER

User searches by vibe: "I'm feeling Date Night" → shows restaurants, lounges, entertainment venues tagged with that vibe. Does NOT show dentists, lawyers, or accountants.

User searches by need: "I need a dentist" → shows dental practices sorted by community trust score and endorsements. No vibes, no "Hood Classic" tag on a dental office.

User browses by culture: "Show me Ethiopian restaurants" → shows Ethiopian restaurants with Habesha Approved badges, Buna Certified tags, and regional slang from that city.

Business gets endorsed: When 10+ community members from the Ethiopian community endorse an Ethiopian restaurant, it earns the "Habesha Approved" badge automatically. The badge is EARNED, not self-assigned.

Kinfolk uses the language: "Since you've been browsing Ethiopian spots, here's one that's Habesha Approved with 47 endorsements — the injera is supposed to be incredible."

IMPLEMENTATION NOTES FOR REPLIT

1. **Add `businessType` field:** "experience" | "service" | "retail" | "community" — determines which discovery features apply
2. **Vibe tags only show on experience + some retail businesses** — never on services or community orgs
3. **Cultural endorsement badges are EARNED** — triggered when X members from that cultural community endorse the business (threshold: 10 for small cities, 25 for large cities)
4. **The system detects which cultural community endorsed** — based on the endorser's heritage profile (from onboarding Step 2)

5. **Multiple badges can coexist** — a Nigerian restaurant in Houston can be "Naija Approved" + "H-Town Certified" + "Hood Classic"
 6. **Professional services get trust-based badges only** — "Community Trusted", "5-Star Professional", etc.
 7. **Remove "Black Professionals" from VALID_CATEGORIES** — replace with just "Professional Services" (already exists)
 8. **Endorsement language is displayed on the business card** — Layer 2 (Community Voice) of the 4-layer profile card
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VERIFICATION

1. Show the businessType classification for 5 example businesses (restaurant, dentist, boutique, nonprofit, barbershop)
2. Confirm vibes do NOT appear on service-type businesses
3. Show how a cultural endorsement badge is earned and displayed
4. Confirm "Black Professionals" category has been removed or renamed
5. Show Kinfolk using cultural endorsement language in a recommendation